

Wa State, 3 May 1968

Docteur Charrière,

Your last letter arrived late, but intact. The rains have made certain roads impassable earlier than expected, and the ever so mortal men who serve as intermediaries in these valleys are ever so cautious.

The quantity of cinnabar requested is ready. I have had the purest portion separated from the rest, according to your instructions, and it will be shipped in the agreed form. The crates will carry no mineral markings. They will first travel with the ordinary product, then be handed to your southern correspondents before continuing toward Saigon. You should receive notice of arrival through a separate channel.

I echo your concern that the material should not be left in the hands of ordinary chemists, who would most likely turn it into truly dead matter. It must of course remain capable of answering what is asked of it. Our benefactor was kind enough to acquiesce us with this method; it would be unfortunate to allow it to be misplaced.

I have also included, as requested, the khmaw chouk seeds. They come from the active cultivation within the compound and have not been dried beyond what was necessary. I must say that I suspect under what conditions our benefactor intends to use them, and I am most thrilled to hear of the results.

Receive the crates, confirm their condition, and tell me whether the seeds are in satisfactory condition.

Enthusiastically,
Ming Yuan